

❑ ATI2evxx.exe is a service that stays in the system tray and runs in the background. Its main function is to serve as a client program, which when activated allows you to use hotkeys for rotating displays, changing resolutions, etc. Your ATI drivers will function if you disable it; this will also rid you of the error message. You can disable ATI2evxx if you don't use it. You can do this by typing in "services.msc" at a command prompt and clicking OK. Scroll through the list to find the ATI Hotkey Poller service, double-click on it, and select "Disabled" under "Startup Type". This should remove the service from being executed, and ultimately, the error itself.

Exploring Processes

❑ I am running Windows XP SP2. My problem is that when my PC boots up, Explorer doesn't start, although it's there in the process list. Moreover, when I kill the Explorer process and start a new one it starts fine. What's up?

Sundeep Baghel

❑ Your problem is most likely the cause of a malfunctioning process at startup. You need to find out which one. To do this, run "msconfig" and click on the Startup tab. Here disable and enable processes one by one and restart your PC after each to pin down the culprit, after which you can disable it.

If you can't find the program that's causing the error, we'd suggest you perform a repair of your OS: boot your computer using the Windows XP CD, and when presented with the options called "To install Windows XP, press enter" and "To repair your computer the recovery console, press R", press [Enter] to perform a new install. When presented with a list of installed OSes, select your Windows XP installation and press [R] to repair it. All your critical files should be now repaired / replaced, and explorer.exe should no longer have problems.

If you still face the problem, it is likely a problem caused by a virus, in which case you should update your anti-virus to the latest version and virus definitions and run a thorough scan.

Stats Lie!

❑ I bought a new Compaq Presario SR1732IL two months ago, which has a Seagate ST3160023AS HDD. When I installed HDDLife Pro 2.0.50, it informed me that my hard disk health and performance are 56%. However, this changes every day—sometimes the health and performance are 54%, sometimes 60%, and sometimes 61%. Is HDDLife displaying correct information?

Abhinav Jangda

❑ HDDLife's health and performance bar aren't spot-on accurate. The bar is only a rough estimate of your HDD's performance / life, and can vary.

I Made A Boo-Boo...

❑ About three weeks ago, my computer started acting weird because of a file I downloaded from the Net. Now from one week ago, a lot of ads have started coming randomly when I log on to the Net. I

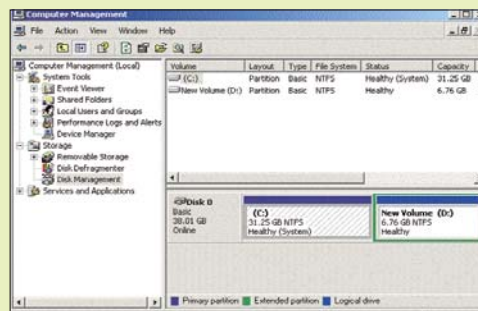
QUESTION
OF THE
MONTH

A Disappearing Drive

❑ I recently repaired Windows XP and installed the drivers from the CD that came with the motherboard. Now whenever I plug in my USB drive, the icon shows up in the System Tray and I can safely remove it, but I cannot access it. It is not displayed in My Computer.

Manu K

❑ First, you need to check whether your USB drive is formatted. To do so, insert your drive into the slot, right-click on My Computer, and click Manage. Next click on Disk Management. Here, if the white space next to your USB drive doesn't say "Unpartitioned Space", then right-click on it and select



Your USB drive will show as an additional disk further below disk 0

"Assign a drive letter or path" or "Create a partition". If it does say "Unpartitioned Space", then create a partition by right-clicking on the white space and choosing that option.

If this doesn't work, you will need to remove your USB drivers from your computer. Go to "System" in the Control Panel. From here, click the Hardware tab and click Device Manager. Scroll down to the area called Universal Serial Bus controllers, and uninstall all of them. Reboot to get the components detected again and install the drivers that came with your USB drives. Plug in your drive—it should work fine.

have used spyware removers but to no avail. Sometimes Net activity continues even when the computer is idle. Please tell me what I should do.

Kunal Singh

❑ Always immediately virus-scan any file you download from the Internet! Anyway, now, boot up in Safe Mode With Networking and run updates on all your spyware removers (Spybot S&D recommended; www.spybot.info) and anti-virus software. Again restart in Safe Mode, but this time, don't choose the Networking option. Run Spybot S&D, perform a full scan, and clean out any entries that come up. Don't forget to use the "Immunize" option on the left hand panel. After the scan is complete, perform another scan using your anti-virus. Finally, run HijackThis (<http://www.merijn.org/>), perform a scan, and clean out any suspicious entries from the scan.

In the future, it's best to use a firewall like ZoneAlarm, which, in addition to keeping a tight check on your downloads, also gives you the option to block ads or unwanted traffic.

Startup Woes Again

❑ I use Windows XP Pro SP2. The problem is that Scandisk does not load at bootup when the computer is switched off without shutting down properly. I think this problem started after I installed Autopatcher XP. What do I do?

Jayakrishnan

❑ In Windows XP, "Chkdsk" (Check Disk) is started if your computer shuts down improperly. You can disable this option to gain a few seconds while booting, or, in your case, you can